



Ministero della Salute

HPAI outbreaks in Italy

PAFF Committee – Animal health and welfare



HPAI H5N1 in Italy

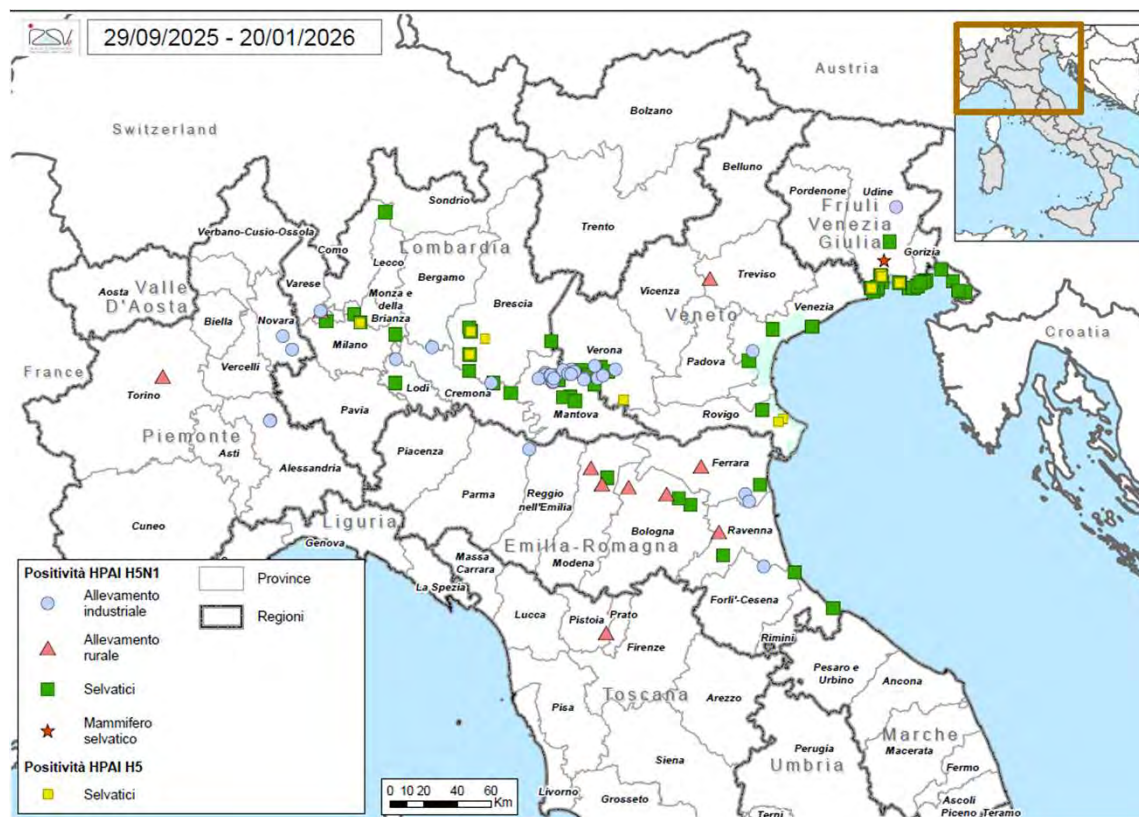
updated 21/01/2026

✓ 51 HPAI outbreaks in poultry (commercial and backyard)

- 24 Lombardia
- 10 Emilia - Romagna
- 10 Veneto
- 5 Piemonte
- 1 Friuli – Venezia Giulia
- 1 Toscana

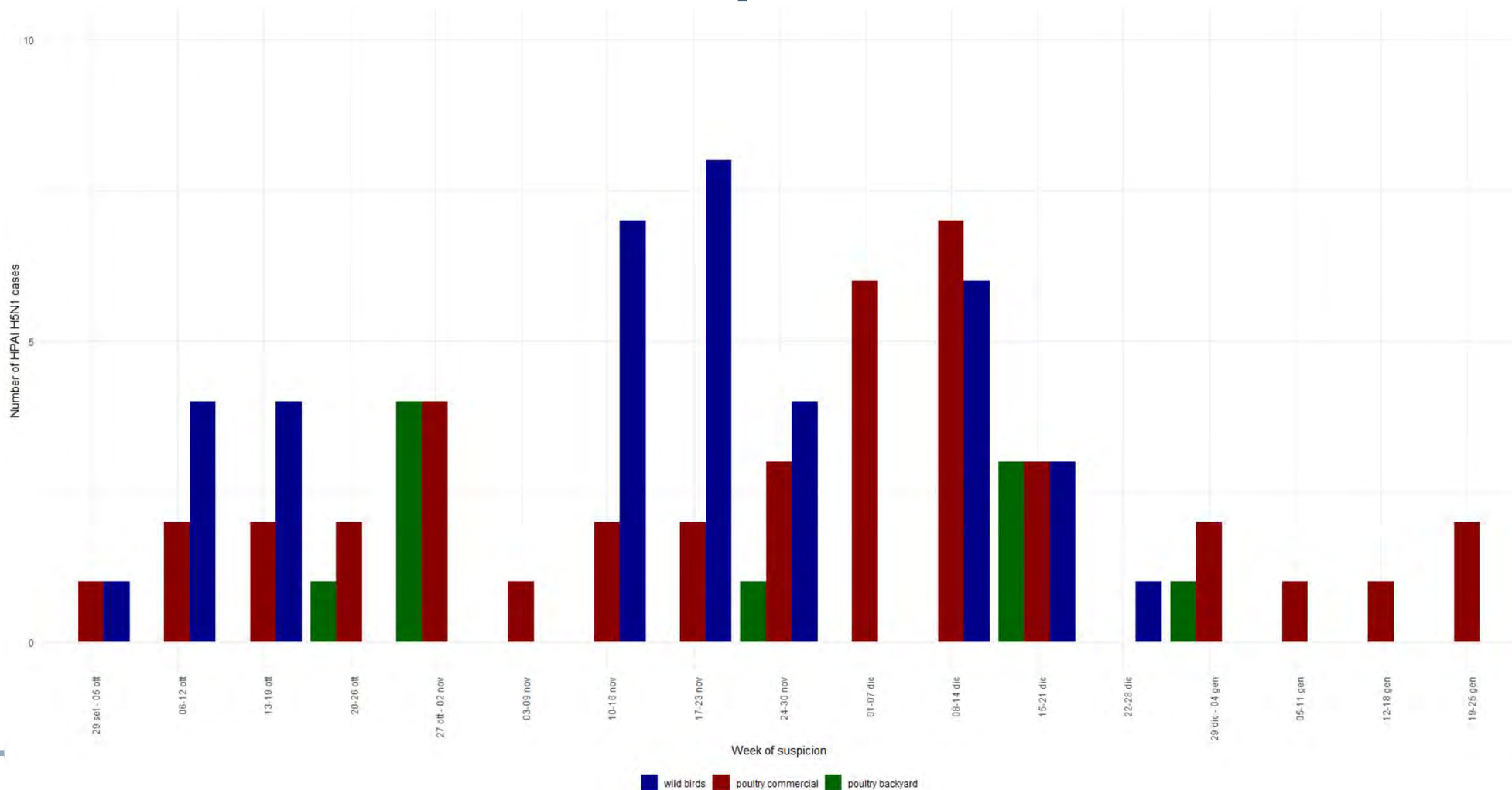
✓ 91 HPAI positive cases in wild birds (161 infected subjects)

- 42 Friuli – Venezia Giulia
- 26 Lombardia
- 16 Veneto
- 7 Emilia - Romagna



Regular update on: <https://www.izsvenezie.com/reference-laboratories/avian-influenza-newcastle-disease/italy-update/>
<https://eurlaidata.izsvenezie.it/>

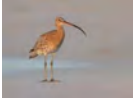
HPAI H5N1 epidemic curve



HPAI H5N1 in poultry

- The epidemic season in poultry started in week 40, matching the onset in 2024, affecting the periphery of the HDPa
- In contrast to 2024, the first cases within the core HDPa were detected about two months earlier

Region	Meat turkey	Broiler	Laying hen	Multispecies	Chicken breeder	Phaasant	Duck	Capon	Total
Emilia-Romagna	3	2	1	4					10
Friuli-Venezia Giulia		1							1
Lombardia	12		8	1		1	1	1	24
Piemonte			1	2	2				5
Toscana				1					1
Veneto	8		1	1					10
Total	23	3	11	9	2	1	1	1	51



HPAI H5N1 in wild birds

- The first cases detected 3 weeks later than in 2024, majority belonging to *Anseriformes* Order, followed by *Charadriiformes*, *Accipitriformes* and *Phoenicopteriformes*
- Positive cases were **mainly** found through **active surveillance** (hunted=89 and trapped=13), followed by passive surveillance (moribound or found dead=66)

Species	Region				Total
	Emilia- Romagna	Friuli-Venezia Giulia	Lombardia	Veneto	
<i>Common buzzard</i>	1		1		2
<i>Common teal</i>	1	6	13	18	38
<i>Eurasian curlew</i>		1			1
<i>Eurasian wigeon</i>		50	1		51
<i>Greater flamingo</i>		1			1
<i>Greylag goose</i>	4	2	2		8
<i>Mallard duck</i>	4		5	6	15
<i>Muscovy duck</i>	1		3		4
<i>Herring gull</i>		1			1
<i>Mute swan</i>		26	15	1	42
<i>Northern shoveler</i>				1	1
<i>Western marsh harrier</i>				1	1
<i>Whooper swan</i>			1		1
<i>Yellow legged gull</i>	2				2
Total	13	87	41	27	168

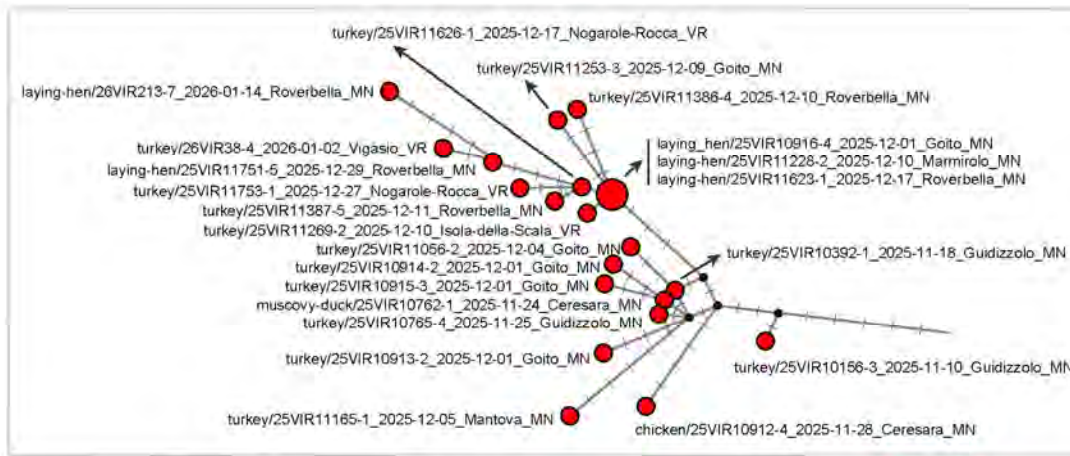
Oubreaks in poultry

- Besides wildlife-mediated introductions, other **risk factors** have been identified:
 - Frequent **movement of transport vehicles**, especially for broiler thinning
 - **Extended loading operations** in large poultry farms
 - Proximity to infected premises
- These risks highlight the importance of **strict, daily biosecurity compliance**, including:
 - Transport vehicle disinfection
 - Cleaning/loading area sanitation
 - Prompt reporting of **mortality increases** or **feed intake drops**, even if mild

Disease control measures as provided by Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2020/687

- Epidemiological investigation
- Culling, disposal of carcasses, cleaning and disinfection procedures
- Establishment of protection and surveillance zones (3 and 10 km)
- Restrictions on movements of poultry and poultry products (with derogations)

Genetic Network with Italian HPAIV sequences



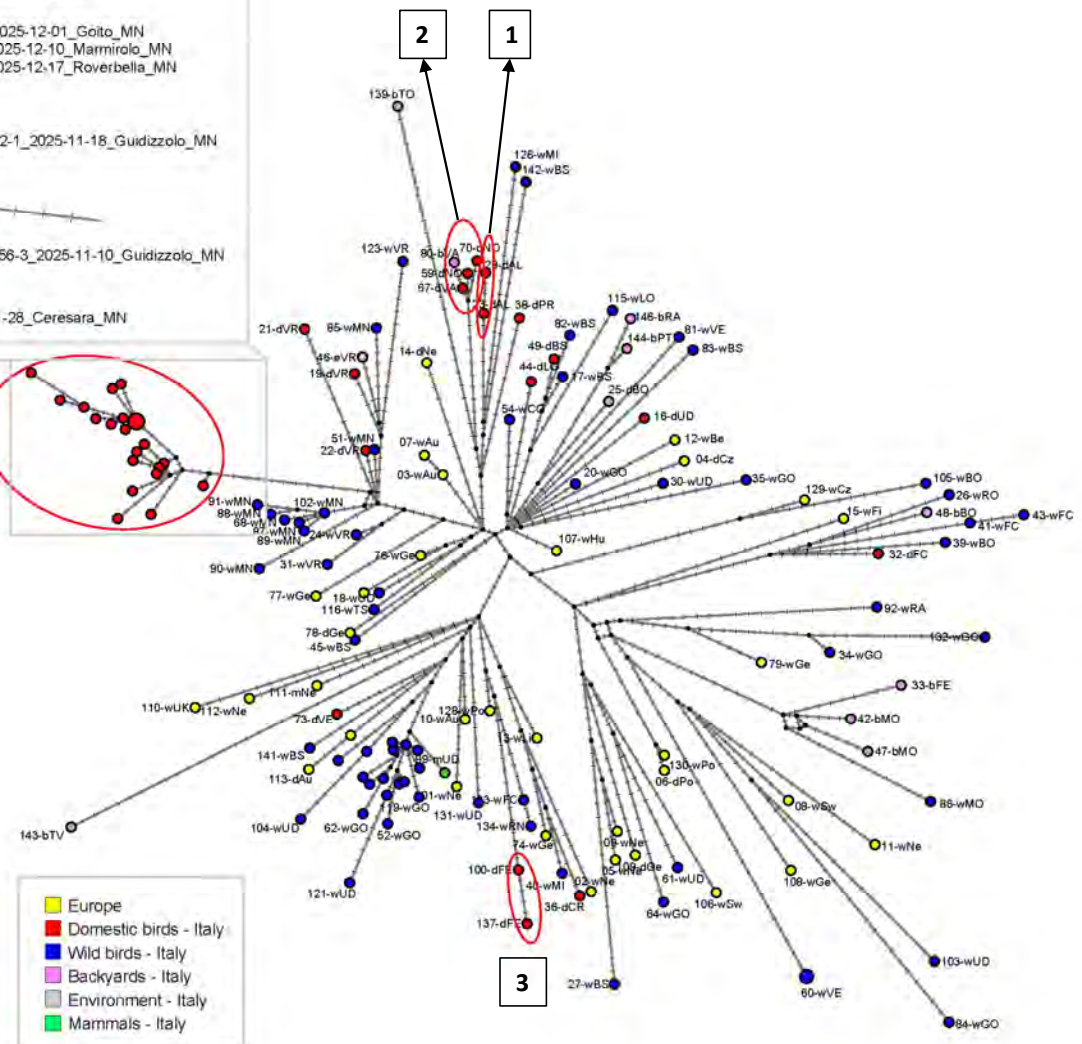
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All HPAI H5N1 viruses identified and analyzed in Italy since September 29, 2025, belong to a new subcluster of the EA-2024-DI.2 genotype, designated **EA-2024-DI.2.1**.

Genetic analysis indicates the occurrence of **19 primary introductions from wild into domestic bird farms**.

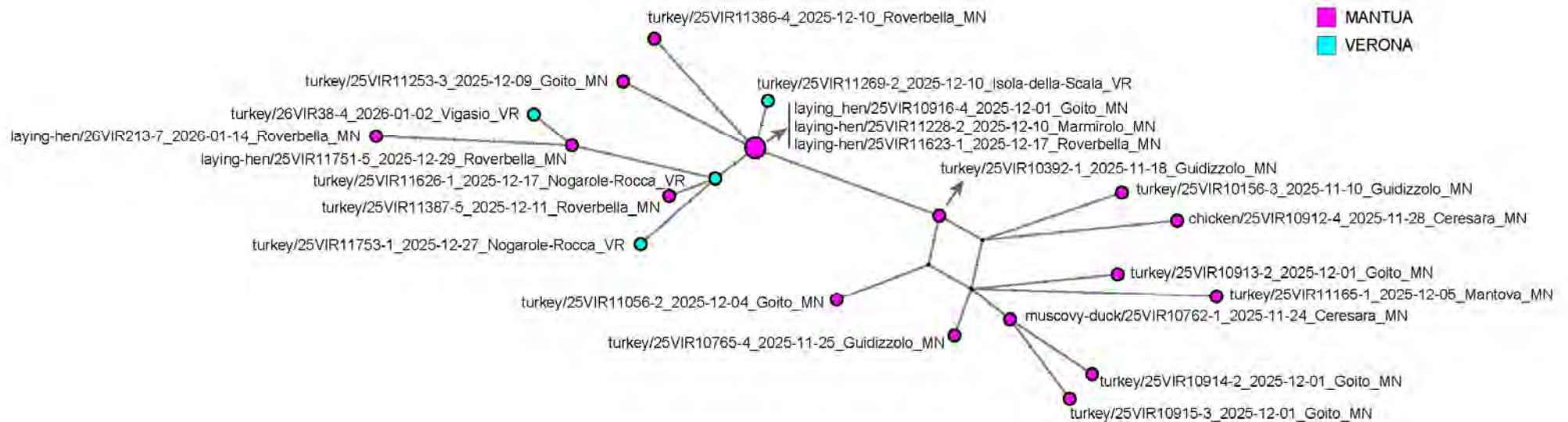
Four secondary transmission events, highlighted by red circles, have been identified in

1. Alessandria Province (16-20 Oct 2025)
2. Novara-Varese Provinces (7-19 Nov 2025)
3. Ferrara Province (9-17 Dec 2025)
4. Mantua-Verona Provinces (10 Nov 2025 – 14 Jan 2026)



Genetic Network – Genotype EA-2024-DI.2.1 – Focus on Mantua-Verona cluster (10 Nov 2025 – 14 Jan 2026)

The largest cluster of secondary transmission events includes **22 poultry outbreaks** occurring across **nine different municipalities**. A west-to-east pattern of spread was observed, with evidence suggesting two independent introductions from the province of Mantua to the province of Verona.



Preventive and risk mitigation measures in place since mid-September

Ministry of Health 15 September 2025, protocol no. 26468

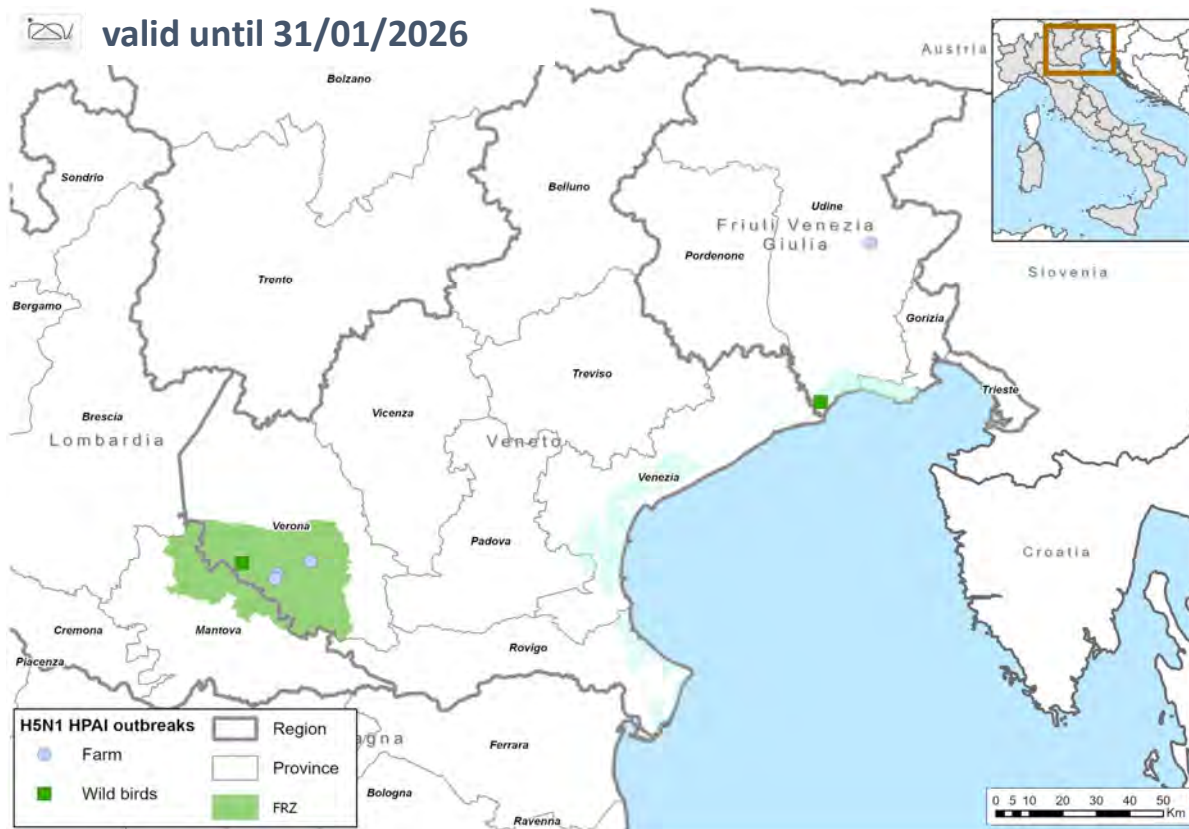
- **Intensification of surveillance in wild bird populations**
- **Adoption of measures to strengthen early detection surveillance**
- **Implementation of measures ensuring a rapid response**
- **Adoption of measures to prohibit outdoor poultry farming**
- **Restocking/housing programme for meat turkeys**
- **Adoption of HPAI prevention and surveillance protocols** in Wildlife Rescue and Rehabilitation Centres
- **Risk-based evaluation** of the possible suspension of markets, fairs, exhibitions
- **Risk-based measures regulating the use of live decoy birds**
- **Provisions for the release and movement of game birds**

Further Restricted Zone in H5PA Veneto and Lombardia

Italian Ministry of Health, 16 October 2025 protocol no. 30074

Main preventive/risk mitigation measures

- Census and confinement
- Enhanced biosecurity
- Movements control
- Restrictions on productive activities:
 - Ban of broiler thinning
 - Ban of markets, fairs, exhibitions
 - Ban on release of game birds for restocking or hunting purposes
 - Ban of meat turkey restocking
- Increased monitoring
- Age limits on slaughtering for meat turkey
- Pre-movement clinical inspection and virological testing
- Enhanced active surveillance for AI in wild birds



Thank you